

Wikipedia Hackathon Overview

Welcome to our first hackathon! This page contains everything you need to know about the project, along with links to essential resources

Project Description

The goal of our first hackathon is to create a fun and engaging Wikipedia-based app.

Goals

1. **Collaboration:** Experience efficient teamwork and effective communication.
2. **Skill Development:** Apply and sharpen your programming skills.
3. **Innovation:** Leverage creativity to design unique features.
4. **Enjoyment:** Have fun while building something together!

Requirements

-  **Console App:** The app should be designed to run in the console.
-  **Real-Time Data Retrieval:** While the app can include some hardcoded information, it must also retrieve real-time data from Wikipedia. You can use methods such as:
 - The [Python Wikipedia-API module](#) (or any other module)
 - The [MediaWiki API](#)
 - Web scraping with [BeautifulSoup](#)
 - Any other suitable method for data retrieval

Collaboration

We strongly recommend using **Git** from the start of the hackathon. Create a shared repository on GitHub and commit your changes regularly. Git makes it easy for everyone to work on the project together, keeps track of changes, and provides a safety net if something goes wrong.

To help your team stay organized, consider using a simple project management tool such as **Trello**, **GitHub Projects**, or even a basic **Kanban board**. Breaking your project into small tasks and keeping them visible helps everyone stay on the same page, share the workload, and track your progress throughout the hackathon.

A few simple habits can make a big difference:

- Keep your task board up to date so everyone knows what's being worked on.
- **Always** `git pull` **before committing new changes** to make sure you're working with the latest version of the project.
- Commit small, meaningful changes often.



AI Policy: Consultant, Not Coder

While AI tools can be helpful, we recommend minimizing their use at this stage of your studies. They may replace the problem-solving process instead of supporting it, hindering your growth as a developer. A key part of the hackathon experience is tackling challenges, developing critical thinking skills, and collaborating as a team. This hands-on approach is essential for your development. Although AI can provide quick answers, relying on it may detract from valuable learning opportunities. Embracing these challenges will deepen your understanding of the development process and enhance your skills.

Clarification on OpenAI Keys:

We can provide you with OpenAI API keys. These are intended to be used **inside your application logic** (e.g., if you want your app to generate summaries or answer user questions).

Using AI to Write Code:

⚠️ Using AI tools (like ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot, etc.) to **write the code for you is not allowed.** ⚠️

To grow as a developer, you need to build your own "coding muscle." While AI can provide a quick fix, it bypasses the critical thinking and debugging process that is an essential part of the hackathon.

The "Consultant" Rule:

If you get stuck, treat AI as a **consultant**, not a coder.

- ❌ **Don't ask:** "Write a function that scrapes Wikipedia."
- ✅ **Do ask:** "I am getting an error with the `requests` library. Can you explain what this error message means?" or "What is the logic flow for a data retrieval function?"

You must write the implementation yourself. If you are struggling, lean on your teammates and your mentor first!

Key resources

- **Wikipedia resources:**
 - [Python Wikipedia-API module](#)
 - [MediaWiki API](#)
 - [BeautifulSoup](#)
- **Walkthrough example - [here](#)**
- **Workflow Chart Tools:**
 - [draw.io](#)
 - [Canva](#)
- **Presentation Templates:**
 - [Idea pitch presentation template](#) (copy from here)
 - [Final presentation template](#) (copy from here)

For more information and other FAQs, please consult the [Hackathon Intro Page](#)

